Things to remember when you write your dissertation ..

Background

To be able to fully understand and appreciate the multiplicity of the IS audit profession and IS auditing concepts, it is essential to determine and define the existing body of knowledge by means of a literature review. The literature review aim to set the background for the study as well as to contribute to a framework defining an IS auditor's profile. In order to define an IS auditor's profile, the roles and responsibilities, knowledge, skills and audit tools and techniques used in performing an IS audit ~~is~~ are illustrated. In this chapter, the evolution of the IS auditing profession are first described, in order to ~~To be able to~~ illustrate ~~understand~~ the IS auditing concepts and the differences between traditional audit, IT and IS audit~~, the evolution of the IS auditing profession will firstly be described~~. ~~–~~Thereafter the IS auditing concept definitions, as obtained from the literature, ~~will be~~are determined and defined. These concepts' definitions ~~will~~ set the outline for the detailed descriptions of the 5 components defining the IS auditor's profile, namely:

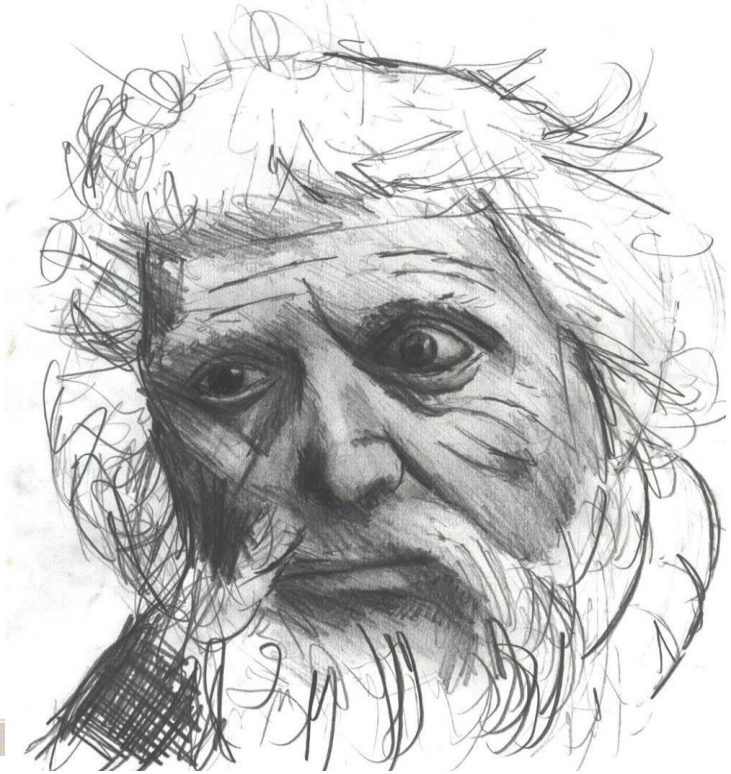
1. The IS auditor's daily roles and responsibilities and the main stages in performing a typical IS audit assignment;
2. The knowledge expected from an IS auditor regarding IT concepts;

Comment [MSOffice3]: Begin eerder. In order to understand

Comment [MSOffice4]: The aim of the literature review is to …

Comment [MSOffice5]: Ek het die vorige sin vir jou verander om die will uit te haal. Moet nie will be en will gebruik nie. Maak die sinne passive current tense soos wat ek in die vorige sin gemaak het.

YOUR MOST IMPORTANT TASK DURING WRITING IS TO WRITE WITH YOUR EXTERNAL REVIEWER / EXAMINER IN MIND



Most important rule during writing is to remember the golden thread!

The Golden Thread – All About Structure

- Planning your argument (use Mind maps)
  - First your outline of your document – use tools such as FreeMind, Mind Manager or TheBrain
  - Then your outline of your Chapter / Sections
  - Then the outline of your paragraphs
  - Then the outline of your sentences

Structure

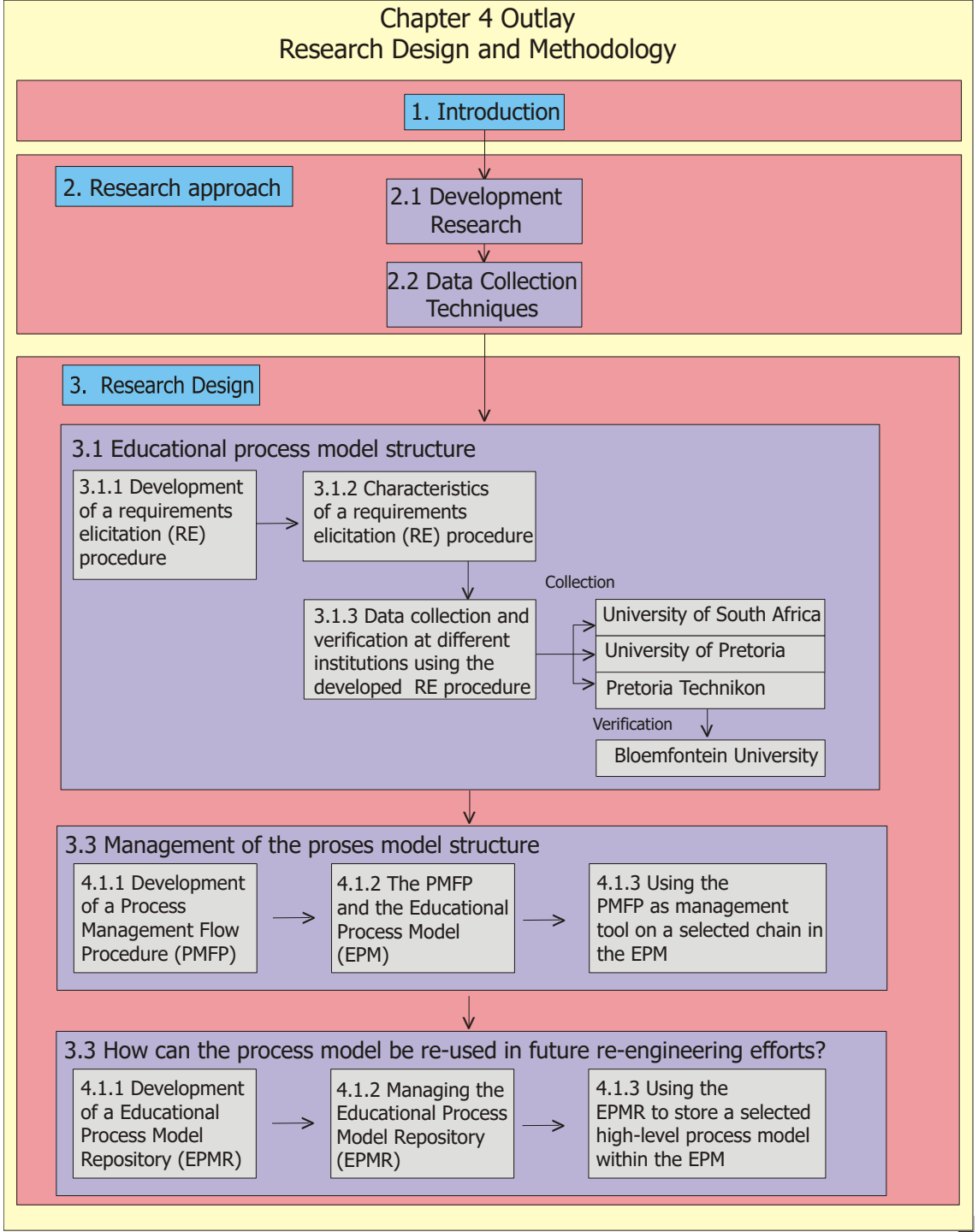
2. THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK 22

2.1 Introduction 22
2.2 Background information 22
2.2.1 The impact of the technological revolution on HEI 23
2.2.2 Re-engineering the processes in an HEI application domain 25
2.3 Process model structure 29
2.3.1 What is a process? 30
2.3.2 Process modelling 31
2.3.3 Process notation 32
2.3.4 Identification of the process model structure 36
2.3.4.1 Process model components identification 36
2.3.4.2 Construction of the process model structure 37
2.3.5 Establishing a generic process model structure 39
2.3.6 Process modelling tools 41
2.3.7 Overview: process model structure 43

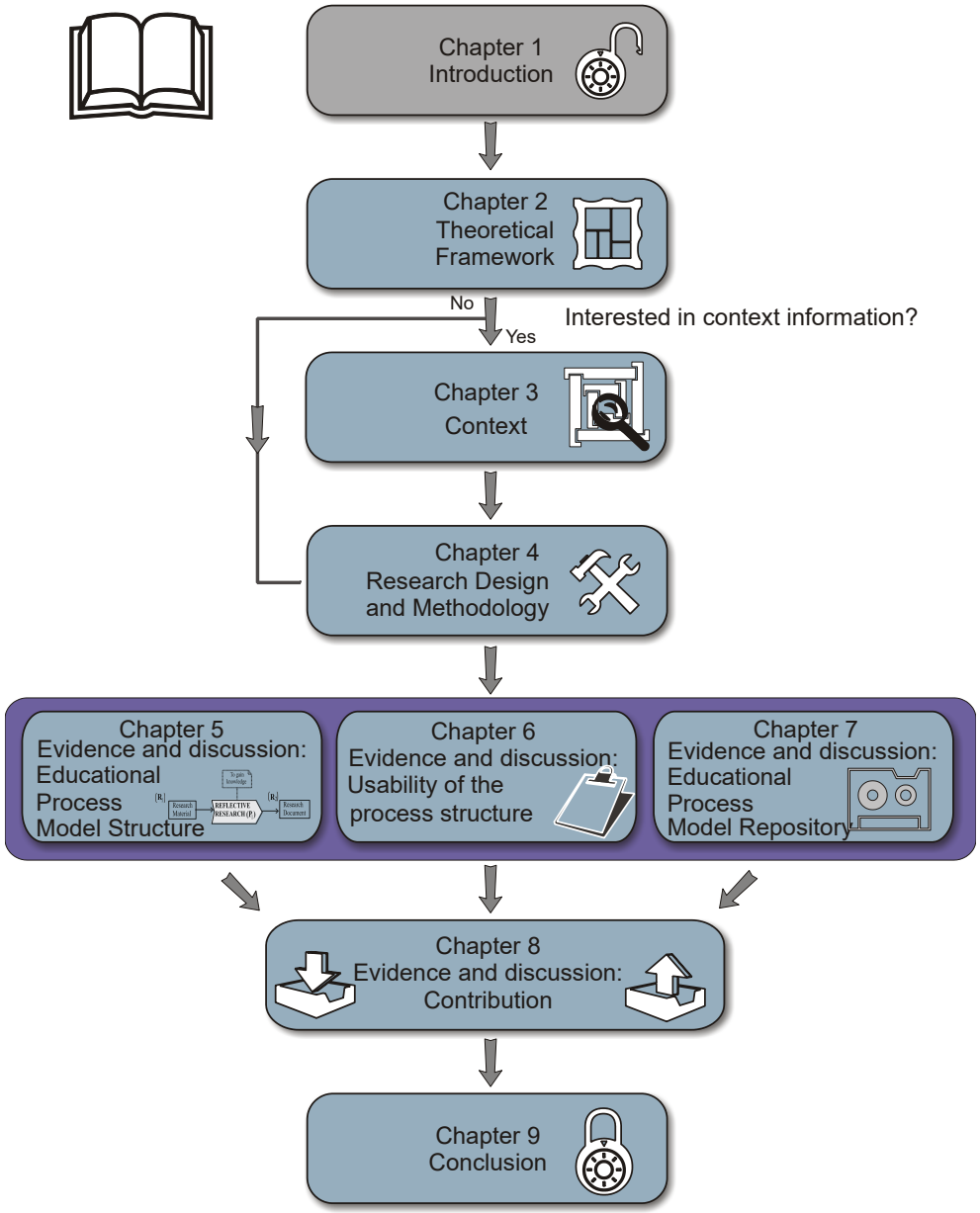
Make your text interesting

- Uninteresting text : Example 1
- Use Bullets, boxes, graphics: Example 2

- Draw up a **Thesis Map / Chapter Map**
  - **Assist in your own thinking and assist the externals thinking processes.**


Chapter 4 Outlay
Research Design and Methodology
1. Introduction
2. Research approach
2.1 Development Research
2.2 Data Collection Techniques
3. Research Design
3.1 Educational process model structure
3.1.1 Development of a requirements elicitation (RE) procedure
3.1.2 Characteristics of a requirements elicitation (RE) procedure
3.1.3 Data collection and verification at different institutions using the developed RE procedure
Collection
University of South Africa
University of Pretoria
Pretoria Technikon
Verification
Bloemfontein University
3.3 Management of the proses model structure
4.1.1 Development of a Process Management Flow Procedure (PMFP)
4.1.2 The PMFP and the Educational Process Model (EPM)
4.1.3 Using the PMFP as management tool on a selected chain in the EPM
3.3 How can the process model be re-used in future re-engineering efforts?
4.1.1 Development of a Educational Process Model Repository (EPMR)
4.1.2 Managing the Educational Process Model Repository (EPMR)
4.1.3 Using the EPMR to store a selected high-level process model within the EPM

Thesis Map


Chapter 1
Introduction
Chapter 2
Theoretical
Framework
No
Yes
Interested in context information?
Chapter 3
Context
Chapter 4
Research Design
and Methodology
Chapter 5
Evidence and discussion:
Educational
Process
Model Structure
Chapter 6
Evidence and discussion:
Usability of the
process structure
Chapter 7
Evidence and discussion:
Educational
Process
Model Repository
Chapter 8
Evidence and discussion:
Contribution
Chapter 9
Conclusion

Make your text interesting

- Uninteresting text : Example 1
- Use Bullets, boxes, graphics: Example 2

- Draw up a **Thesis Map / Chapter Map**
    - **Assist in your own thinking and assist the externals thinking processes.**

- Think like the external .. What looks nice – what makes text interesting?

Although it is relatively easy to illustrate the process of modelling in a book or at a lecture, in real life there are problems. It is importa to realize that there is no logical point at which level the detail stops. This is a pragmatic decision. Certainly, design teams can put too much effort into the development of the model. Some decisions are based on the way in which the data is used. An example of this could be entity occurences of persons who are female where they relate to:

- Patients in a hospital
- students at University
- readers in a library.

Scientific Writing

- Sweeping statements
  - I felt
  - Elicitation is all about
  - Requirements elicitation is becoming a big issue for companies that produce software.
  - It is important to note … says who?
  - Having read carefully about … eekhhh!

Scientific Writing

- Tense:
  - Use active voice.

Avoid starting sentences with "I" or "we": this pulls focus away from the scientific topic at hand.
Avoid using "I" or "we" when you're making a conjecture, whether it's substantiated or not. Everything you say should follow from logic, not from personal bias or subjectivity. Never use any emotive words in conjunction with "I" or "we" (e.g., "I believe," "we feel," etc.).
Never use "we" in a way that includes the reader (e.g., "here we see trait evolution in action"); the use of "we" in this context sets a condescending tone.
http://www.unc.edu/depts/wcweb/handouts/sciences.html

Arguments for the use of “I”

Amir (2005)

Scientific Writing

- Tense:
  - Use active voice.

Be direct. *A hit B* describes the event more concisely than *B was hit by A.* The passive is often used to conceal the identity of the person who is actually responsible for something unpleasant. An inspector might write: *It is felt that you have no grounds for complaint* when he is reluctant to admit plainly that it is he who feels that way himself.

KISS

- Keep your writing style simple and easy to understand ..

A quality learning system is the foundation of virtual distance learning. It represents not only a significant investment and a competitive edge for a particular learning institution, but is also crucial to the success of the learning process. The integration of the heritage systems and legacy data into a network-centric environment involves more than just connecting data and hardware to the Internet - it requires the ability to make intelligent trade-offs that extend the scope of, and harvest the investment in, these systems. The systems engineer must design a strategy for the implementation and maintenance of a quality learning system. This quality is parametrized by factors such as feasibility, schedule, flexibility and maintenance, chronological instability, and scalability and expandability. In this paper, we describe how these parameters affect the quality of a virtual learning system, and attempt to reduce unforeseen systems engineering problems when developing a new virtual learning system.

KISS

- Keep your writing style simple and easy to understand ..

A good learning system is really important for online learning. It's like the base that helps online learning work well. It's not only a big investment and an advantage for a school, but it's also really important for making online learning successful. When we bring old systems and data into the online world, it's not just about connecting them to the Internet. We need to be smart about how we do it, so we can use these old systems well and make them even better. The person in charge of this, called a systems engineer, has to make a plan for how to set up and take care of this good learning system. This system should be good in terms of things like being doable, on time, flexible, easy to keep up, not changing too much, and able to grow bigger if needed. In this paper, we talk about how these things affect the quality of an online learning system. We also try to figure out ways to avoid unexpected problems when making a new online learning system.

On Numbers

- In text, write out the numbers in words from one to nine *some countries twelve, then use figures for numbers from 10 (or 13) upwards.
- You may use numbers lower than 10/12 in the case of scientific units, numerals that include a decimal point or a fraction, and when you use the percentage sign, for example *5 kg*, *4.25, 4¼, 7%*.
- Never start a sentence with a number, write out the number in full.

Format

- Key variables for high legibility are font size, font and space between lines (“leading” pronounced “ledding”). A size of 11 pt is the generally recommended standard. Often tables and figures require a smaller font to make optimum use of space. Ensure that you do not use a size smaller than 9 pt since it becomes difficult to read. Use single space and one column only in documents.

Format

- The typeface for body text should be quiet, simple and regular to ensure that the eye moves easily from one word/sentence to the next. Generally, the serif fonts (a type with tiny strokes or projections at the end of each letter such as Times Roman as used in this example) look authoritative and official, but its narrow character makes it more suitable for newspaper columns..

Format

- The sans serif fonts such as the one used in this slide (Arial) are recommended for documents. They look good in any application. Sans serif fonts tend to be plain, unfussy and very compact, allowing the reader to focus on the content of the document. They make an especially strong impact in bold.

Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs
- Some general recommendations

Some nasty NO NOs

- Some mistakes:
  - This report will follow the same trend
  - More information can be found at – Rather: The interested reader may consult
  - Specified here are reasons … vs The following are reasons
  - It says that …– Carefull for IT .. What is IT?
  - Don’t ever get to familiar – e.g. telling stories …

NO NOs

- Be careful of:
  - Here are a number of reasons .. Vs The following are some of the reasons ..
  - Most times it is difficult …
  - As you can see in Figure 1 .. Vs In Figure 1 the concept is illustrated ..

Writing errors

- Consistency
  - Capitalization of words : remember Chapter 1, Table 1, capitalized and section 1 not.
  - Bullets, Lists
- References: According to Smith (Smith, 2004). This is wrong – should be According to Smith (2004)
- NEVER EVER EVER EVER reference Wikipedia!!!!!!

Some mistakes

- Consistency with page layout – always start on the left :

The company has in the past decade focused on a branch of avionics classified as health and usage monitoring systems or HUMS. A HUMS typically monitors various parameters to establish the status of the health or airworthiness of the aircraft and to record its usage or life consumption. The purpose of a HUMS is to improve safety and to provide data to facilitate the management of a fleet of aircraft.

In spite of limiting its focus, the company's level of benefit from software reuse remains limited. This situation is becoming a greater concern as the increase in competition in the industry translates into a demand for productivity and quality improvements.

A preliminary search revealed that most of the published software reuse success stories feature large organisations with ample resources, large R&D budgets and huge development

Citation and plagiarism

This talk will not discuss the various popular citation styles, but it is essential to point out that anything that is not your own work and that is not properly cited amounts to plagiarism, which is tantamount to academic suicide. The more references you cite, however, the more you show that you have read the relevant literature, and that you are able to synthesize that (Cronje,2005).

Citation and plagiarism

Please note this warning! Plagiarism is perhaps the most common, and the most avoidable, reason an assignment or dissertation may be failed. To plagiarize is to present as your own work materials copied or closely paraphrased from someone else without acknowledging the original author. Whether published or unpublished materials, from a noted authority or from another student, directly appropriating the work of others without giving due and appropriate credit is plagiarism.

Part of the commitment of being a supervisor is to ensure that the work that you are doing are your own – at UNISA most of the work submitted within the School of Computing are send through TURNITIN where we can see the duplication from other material.

Chiwhawha, Gibson	Ontologies	36%		.pdf	60674627	02-11-08
Chimamiwa, Gibson 2	Ontologies Databases	24%		.pdf	60674823	02-11-08

Some mistakes made in Tables/Figures

In Table 1 a summary of .. is found (no description).

In Figure 1 a data flow diagram of … is given.

There must be a description of the table/figure.

- Figures in text please … Except if explicitly stated by journal

- Figure/Table directly after you have referenced it.

THERE MUST BE A DESCRIPTION OF WHAT EVER IS IN THIS TABLE/FIGURE.

Some General Recommendations

- In writing the dissertation/thesis – begin by reading some of the theses supervised by your supervisor (You MUST read at least 5 theses before writing your own).

Link to existing theses/dissertations

- https://repository.up.ac.za/handle/2263/31741

Some General Recommendations

- In writing the dissertation/thesis – begin by reading some of your supervisor's students work – ask your supervisor.
- Use GRAPHICS to illustrate. People are graphical inclined.
- Get hold of some evaluation material – e.g. be a reviewer at conferences if you are writing an article

Some General Recommendations

Reviewer Name:		Manuscript Number:	
Date Review:			
Title of Manuscript:			

Which category describes this manuscript?

	Practice/Application/Case
	Study/Experience Report
	Research/Technology
	Survey/Tutorial/How-To
	Other (please specify)

Are the title, abstract, and keywords appropriate? Please comment.

	Yes
	No
Comments	

Rate the paper in each of the following areas (1 = low ; 5 = high):

	1	2	3	4	5
Relevance to journal					
Technical content					
Originality					
Significance/Value to international audience					
Clarity/Organisation					
Mechanics/Grammar					

GENERAL COMMENTS

Discuss the contribution made by the manuscript:	
Comment on the technical content of the manuscript:	
Comment on the organisational and writing style of the manuscript:	
Comment on the appropriateness for the journal (timeliness, broad appeal, etc):	
Comment on the evaluation methodology used (if applicable):	

Does the manuscript contain sufficient and appropriate references? Please comment.

	References are sufficient and appropriate
	Important references are missing; more references are needed
	Number of references are excessive
Comments:	

Suggestions for improvement to the paper:	

Final Recommendation:

	Definitely accept
	Accept only if room
	Borderline
	Reject (poor quality)
	Other (please specify)

Some General Recommendations

- In writing the dissertation/thesis – begin by reading some of your supervisor's students work – https://studierendenprojekte.wirtschaft.fhnw.ch/en
- Use GRAPHICS to illustrate. People are graphical inclined.
- Link to evaluation form in student information link.

Some General Recommendations

- Another common mistake in writing a dissertation is not explaining different terms the writer uses.
- Use a reference tool such as Zotero/Mendeley
- Get a technical reader …
- Buy Grammarly to assist with writing

Working effectively

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z7e7gtU3PHY&ab_channel=TEDxTalks

Questions?

Some References

References

Burrell, G. & Morgan, G. 1979. *Sociological Paradigms and organizational analysis*. London: Heinemann.
Cronje, J (2006), Academic Writing by Numbers, Pretoria.
Mouton, J. (2001) *How to succeed in your Masters' and Doctoral Studies.* Pretoria: Van Schaiks

Helpful Links

The Graduate School of Education and Human Development, Doctoral Student Services Web Guide-http://gwu.edu/~docgsehd
APA-Style Helper (software)- www.apa.org/apa-style
PhinishedD: ABD Discussion and Support Group- www.phinished.org
Advice on Research and Writing-
www.cs.cmu.edu/afs/cs.cmu.edu/user/mleone/web/how-to.html
Association for Support of Graduate Students- www.asgs.org
Electronic Reference Formats Recommended by the American Psychological Association- www.apa.org/journals/webref.html